

What else to watch: *The Big Heat* (1953, p.332) ■ *Le Doulos* (1962) ■ *In Cold Blood* (1967) ■ *A Short Film about Killing* (1988) ■ *Insomnia* (1997) ■ *Zodiac* (2007) ■ *Three Monkeys* (2008) ■ *Leviathan* (2014)

hog-tied and buried in the ground, Naci is the only one in his team to react to the sight truthfully, and for that he is taken aside and sternly told to behave more professionally.

Due process

A similar incident occurs later in the movie when Doctor Cemal (Muhammet Uzuner) conducts an autopsy and discovers something horrific about the death. Like the police officers, the doctor is not allowed to be affected. All he can do is suppress his feelings, write up his report, and stare through the window at the victim's family as they walk away—just as he will have to do next time, and the time after that.

The practicalities of due process mean that good men are asked to treat horror in the same way that the monsters they are hunting treat it; they surrender their right to feel, because papers need to be filed and the process needs to be respected.



Nuri Bilge Ceylan Director

Nuri Bilge Ceylan was born in 1959 in Istanbul, Turkey, and studied electrical engineering. His first movie, *The Town*, gained him instant international acclaim. His third movie, *Distant*, won a host of awards, and he continued to enjoy critical success with *Three*

Monkeys (2008) and *Once Upon a Time in Anatolia*. He won the Palme d'Or at Cannes in 2014 for *Winter Sleep*.

Key movies

1997 *The Town*
2002 *Distant*
2011 *Once Upon a Time in Anatolia*
2014 *Winter Sleep*

Once Upon a Time in Anatolia is a thoughtful, original take on some very well-covered ground. It is not interested in presenting the police as unflappable action heroes, or lawyers as righteous crusaders, or doctors as kind and benevolent. Rather, it focuses on the human cost of being required to witness and interact with the worst of humanity. The metaphor of one endless night symbolizes the

trajectory of the characters' own lives: each of them is destined to be worn down by their job until they reach the point of degradation, just like the body they must find to eventually put in the ground. There is no rest, and no end in sight. ■

Kenan (Firat Tanis, center) is one of two suspects who must travel with the police in order to help them find the murder victim's body.

